RED BANNER ALERT

mainroads WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident	7th April 2026	**Time of Incident**	12:00 PM
Directorate / Region	RMO – Kimberley	**Main Roads or Contractor**	Main Roads
EQSafe Event Type	Procedure Breach	**EQSafe Incident Number**	57801
Actual Consequence	Moderate	**Potential Consequence**	Major

Incident Short Description	Chain used for recovery of maintenance truck, snaps and recoils, smashing through mesh guard and windscreen.

What Happened

Maintenance crews were enroute to Warmun and had stopped to repair a pothole. As they pulled over on to the road shoulder (approximately 100km west of Kununurra), the flocon truck has become bogged. The crew made multiple attempts to reverse out of the bog, to no avail.

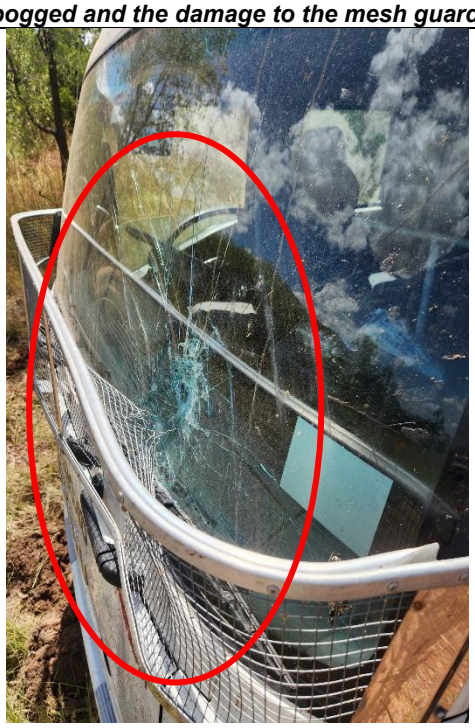
A check of the other truck and light vehicle confirmed that there was no recovery gear available, so the crew have used a 10mm chain which was being used to lash down the posi-track. They've attached the chain to the back of the posi-track and the front of the flocon truck and slowly moved forward to start pulling the flocon out of the bog.

The posi-track was positioned approximately 6 metres from the flocon when the chain has failed under the load, snapping, recoiling and smashing through the mesh windscreen guard and then the windscreen. There was no one on foot at the time (one driver in the flocon, one in the posi-track and another approximately 20 metres away in a light vehicle). Had there been workers on foot, this incident may have had the potential for serious injury or fatality due to chain strike.

The crew abandoned the truck recovery and called the incident through to their supervisor. The Supervisor then arranged for a heavy tow to be mobilised from Kununurra.

The tow truck arrived at the site at approximately 2:40 PM when recovery commenced. Both truck and crews returned to Kununurra. An ICAM investigation has commenced.

Images of truck bogged and the damage to the mesh guard and windscreen



WorkSafe have been notified and a formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to
Mobile Plant

Distribution of Notice	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations